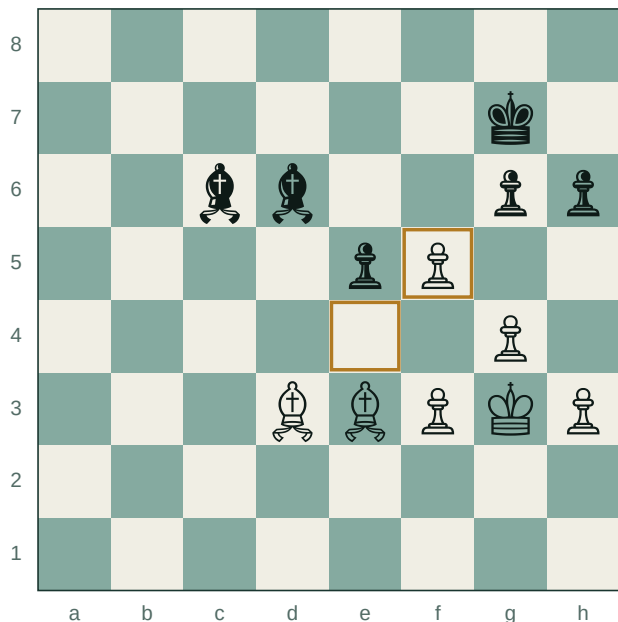


Discovered checks: Black, move 38

Discovered checks

Black to move



Previous move: 38.exf5. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

38...e4+ 39. f4 exd3

38...e4+ Check restricts White to 5 legal replies here. The changed line means the bishop on d6 attacks the king on g3. Recorded reply: **39.f4**.

39...exd3 The pawn captures the bishop on d3.

At the end, nominal material is White 7 / Black 9 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +3. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +3:** the balance goes from -1 to +2. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

The checking line must actually be clear, and moving the blocker must not expose your own king to check.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A discovered check opens a line toward the king by moving the blocking piece. Because check must be answered, the moving piece may gain a free tempo for another threat.

HOW TO LOOK

Trace the hidden checking line first. Then examine where the blocker can move to attack or capture something important.

The defending king is on g3. Geometrically undefended: bishop on e3 and bishop on d3. Check for tactical protection.